

Max Pienkny

Department of Economics
Northwestern University
2211 Campus Dr, Evanston, IL 60208

mpienkny@u.northwestern.edu
maxpienkny.github.io
(925) 683-7179

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Applied Microeconomics; Industrial Organization; Health Economics; Political Economy

EDUCATION

Northwestern University 2021–present

Ph.D. in Economics, expected June 2027

Dissertation Committee: Molly Schnell (Chair), Hannes Schwandt, Igal Hendel, and Gaston Illanes

Stanford University 2015–2019

B.A. in Economics, with Honors

JOB MARKET PAPER

“The Safety Cost of Attribute-Based Environmental Regulation: Evidence from Fuel-Economy Standards”

WORKING PAPERS

“Churches and Local Economies” (with Zane Kashner)

“From the Dial to the Aisle: The Effects of Talk Radio”

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Understanding the Short- and Long-Term Impacts of School-Based Health Centers” (with Marika Cabral, Bokyoung Kim, Adrienne Sabety, Maya Rossin-Slater, Molly Schnell, and Hannes Schwandt)

“Learning-by-Doing versus Training-Cohort in Medical Decision-Making” (with Claire Boone and Molly Schnell)

“Making an Echo Chamber: Selection and Persuasion in Ideological Segregation Online”

JOURNAL ARTICLES

Pienkny, M., M. Rossin-Slater, M. Schnell, and H. Schwandt (2024). “The Lasting Impacts of School Shootings on Youth Psychotropic Drug Use.” *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 114: 387–393.

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

NBER Summer Institute (Urban Economics) — “Churches and Local Economies”	July 2026
ASHEcon Annual Conference — “Churches and Local Economies”	June 2026
ASHEcon Annual Conference — “The Safety Cost of Attribute-Based Environmental Regulation: Evidence from Fuel-Economy Standards”	June 2026
AEA Annual Meeting (ASSA) — “Understanding the Short- and Long-Term Impacts of School-Based Health Centers”	January 2026

EXPERIENCE

Northwestern University <i>Research Assistant for Prof. Molly Schnell</i>	2023–present <i>Evanston, IL</i>
Northwestern University <i>Research Assistant for Prof. Bernard Black</i>	2022 <i>Evanston, IL</i>
Opportunity Insights at Harvard University <i>Pre-doctoral Fellow for Profs. Raj Chetty, John Friedman, and Nathaniel Hendren</i>	2019–2021 <i>Cambridge, MA</i>
Economic Policy Research Center <i>Economic Researcher</i>	2018 <i>Tbilisi, Georgia</i>

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant , ECON 307 – Economics of Medical Care, Northwestern University, Winter 2025 Instructor: Molly Schnell – Average overall TA rating: 5.93/6; median: 6/6

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship <i>National Science Foundation</i>	2021–2026
Robert Eisner Graduate Fellowship <i>Department of Economics, Northwestern University</i> Awarded for excellence in research and teaching	2025–2026

Susan Schmidt Bies Prize

2024

Department of Economics, Northwestern University

Awarded for best 3rd-year research paper

Anna Laura Myers Prize for Outstanding Honors Thesis

2019

*Department of Economics, Stanford University***DEPARTMENT AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE**

Discussant, ASHEcon Annual Conference

June 2026

Co-organizer of Northwestern's Applied Microeconomics Lunch
Seminar

2023–2024

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Programming Skills: Stata, R, Python, Julia

Last updated: August 1, 2026